

The Anonymous Coding Model Developers Used for a Week Was Z.ai's GLM-5.3 Flash

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For six days in August, one of the busiest coding models on the internet had no name. Ox Alpha appeared free on [OpenRouter](#) and OpenCode on August 20, 2026, credited only to “a third-party provider who has chosen to remain anonymous.” It accepted text, images, and video, carried a 1M-token context window, and let developers tune its reasoning effort. On August 26, Z.ai ended the guessing: Ox Alpha was [GLM-5.3-Flash](#), a 320B-parameter model

with just 18B active, and what Z.ai calls the first natively multimodal model in its GLM-5 series. Z.ai says it served every request on [100,000 Chinese-made chips](#).

The draw was price. Z.ai says GLM-5.3-Flash scores 57 on Artificial Analysis's Intelligence Index at about \$0.045 per task, a level it claims once cost roughly ten times more, and it lands close to Claude Opus 4.8 on agentic coding. On OpenRouter it lists at \$0.075 and \$0.25 per million input and output tokens, and the [weights](#) now sit on Hugging Face under an MIT licence. For a week, developers pointed real repositories at an endpoint with no named owner and no model card.

A model nobody could name topped OpenRouter's usage chart that week, and Z.ai collected real agent traffic plus a name-making buzz before it published anything. Developers got a cheap, fast coding model. What they did not get was a name they could check.

Read More: [GLM-5.3, Z.ai's flagship reasoning model, which shipped two weeks earlier with a focus on finding software vulnerabilities](#)

Sources:

- [GLM-5.3-Flash: Frontier Intelligence, Flash Cost \(Z.ai\)](#)
- [GLM 5.3 Flash model page and pricing \(OpenRouter\)](#)
- [GLM-5.3-Flash weights on Hugging Face](#)
- [Z.ai shares surge 8% after releasing new AI model running only on Chinese chips \(CNBC\)](#)

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